

threatened mutiny and mass desertion if he failed to see General Grant to discuss terms.

On July 3, the same day that Pickett's Charge was repulsed at Gettysburg, John C. Pemberton, the Pennsylvania-born Southern general, met with Ulysses S. Grant, the former Illinois leather tanner, and agreed to surrender his army. Grant wanted to make the terms "unconditional surrender" as before, but soon realized that 30,000 Rebel prisoners headed north would swamp Union logistical capacity in the area. He therefore paroled every one of Pemberton's men, expecting to fight some of them again. Indeed, well over half of Vicksburg's captured defenders broke their parole. In fact, some were in action again with the Confederate army later in 1863.



Refuge from the siege

Many of the civilian population of Vicksburg abandoned their homes because of the incessant bombardments from Union river gunboats, and took refuge in caves dug into the hillsides. Only a handful of Vicksburg civilians died from enemy action.